NACEP

What is Concurrent Enrollment

Concurrent and dual enrollment partnerships provide high school students the opportunity to take college credit-bearing courses. NACEP defines concurrent enrollment as the subset of dual enrollment courses taught by college-approved high school teachers **in a secondary environment**. Concurrent and dual enrollment partnerships and early college programs **successfully** transition students from high school to college.

Concurrent enrollment is a low-cost, scalable model for bringing college courses to students in urban, suburban, and rural high schools and secondary career centers. Students gain exposure to the academic challenges of college while in their supportive high school environment, earning transcripted college credit at the time they successfully pass the course.

Concurrent enrollment also facilitates close collaboration between high school teachers and college faculty that fosters alignment of secondary and postsecondary curriculum.

Sometimes called “dual credit,” “dual enrollment,” “college in the high school,” or “early college,” concurrent enrollment differs from other models of dual enrollment because high school instructors teach the college courses.

TYPES OF DUAL ENROLLMENT COURSEWORK

Concurrent enrollment courses share some elements or characteristics with other dual enrollment models, such as programs in which:

- A high school student travels to the college campus.
- College faculty travel to the high school or secondary career center.
- A high school student takes a course from a college instructor via distance education, either synchronous via interactive video or an asynchronous online platform.

DISTINCT FROM OTHER TECHNICAL COURSE ALIGNMENT MECHANISMS

- Articulated credit is provided when an individual college retroactively assigns credit for high school coursework upon matriculation. In concurrent and dual enrollment courses, students receive a transcript based on performance in a college course.

DIFFERENT FROM CREDIT BY EXAM OPTIONS

- Advanced Placement, International Baccalaureate, and Project Lead the Way are advanced high school courses where standardized tests are used to assess students' knowledge at the end of a course. Some colleges and universities will place students out of entry-level courses and/or provide credit-by-exam based on students' performance on these exams.
- Concurrent and dual enrollment courses are actual credit-bearing college courses.

- Concurrent and dual enrollment students earn a college grade based on multiple and varied assessments throughout a course, not just from one high-stakes test.
- Concurrent and dual enrollment students earn transcripted college credit at the time they successfully pass the course, not retroactively for prior learning.

CONTACT US

919.593.5205

Address:
179 E Franklin St, #578
Chapel Hill, NC 27514

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